

Grigorii Sobol



Senior Software Engineer Systems · Compilers · Distributed runtimes

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 - **Location:** Belgrade, Serbia
 - **Open to:** remote and relocation in EU / UK / US
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Summary

Senior software engineer and team lead with 10+ years on performance-critical systems — compilers, binary translation, JIT/WASM runtimes, distributed consensus, and applied cryptography, mostly in Rust and C++. Currently leading Vara.eth at Gear Technologies, an Ethereum coprocessor I architect from the consensus layer down to the WASM runtime. Targeting AI compute-infrastructure roles: runtimes, compilers, and performance engineering for large-scale, compute-hungry workloads.

Work experience

Senior Software Engineer — Gear Technologies

September 2021 — present Remote (gear-tech.io) · L1 protocol / distributed systems

- **Team lead of Vara.eth** since January 2026 — own the architecture end-to-end: a coprocessor for Ethereum with fast BFT consensus on Malachite, the Gear protocol for program execution, and governance through Ethereum smart contracts.
- Core developer of the **Vara Network L1** (Substrate-style runtime) in Rust.
- Contributed fixes and extensions to WebAssembly sandboxing and JIT / runtime internals — Wasmer, Wasmi, dlmalloc.
- Implemented protocol-critical cryptography — secp256k1, FROST threshold signatures, DLEQ proofs.
- Drive solutions from design through merged, production code and review.

- **Work examples:**

- dlmalloc port for Gear WASM programs — <https://github.com/gear-tech/dlmalloc-rust>
- Malachite BFT for Vara.eth — <https://github.com/gear-tech/gear/pull/5419>
- Lazy memory accesses — <https://github.com/gear-tech/gear/pull/639>

Lead Software Engineer — Huawei Technologies

August 2019 — September 2021 · Moscow · Telecommunications / Mobile Communications

- Developed optimizations for a Linux-based universal binary translator, improving target-code performance by up to ~50% on key workloads.
- Improved translator stability and built performance-testing tooling for its runtime environments.

Engineer / Programmer — NVIDIA (Russian Branch)

August 2018 — August 2019 · Moscow

Designed and implemented a new compilation phase in a production binary translator, expanding its optimization opportunities for target code.

Senior / Junior Software Engineer — Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology

September 2016 — July 2018 · Laboratory of Complex Organizational and Technological Systems (SLOTS)

Built an LLVM-based back-end compiler and a simulator for a digital signal processor (C++), plus the test infrastructure and build system (Python 2/3, Bash, CMake).

Trainee Programmer — Intel Corporation

August 2015 — August 2016 · Moscow

Compiler-team development for the Intel Compiler (C++); system-administration automation (Bash, Python).

Skills

Languages · Rust · C/C++ · Python · Bash · x86-64 / ARM assembly

Compilers & runtimes · LLVM · binary translation · WASM · JIT / runtime internals · GDB

Systems & tooling · Linux · ARM · CMake · Git · performance analysis

Distributed systems & cryptography · BFT consensus · Ethereum · Solidity · secp256k1 / FROST / DLEQ · ZK

Education

Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology (MIPT)

- M.S., Applied Mathematics and Physics — 2019
- B.S., Applied Mathematics and Physics — 2016

Languages

- Russian — Native
 - English — C1, Advanced
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About me

Where I'd like to go next: the compute infrastructure underneath AI. I'm less drawn to building the models themselves than to the systems they run on — making large-scale, compute-hungry workloads faster and more efficient through performance engineering, runtimes, and compilers.

Off-hours: piano, sport, travel. Driver's license category B.